

Keynote Talk

Agile, Open Source, Distributed, and On-Time – Inside the Eclipse Development Process

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Abstract

Eclipse is a widely recognized open source project dedicated to providing a platform for developing integrated tools. Throughout the history of Eclipse the development team was successful in hitting projected delivery dates with precision and quality. This isn't possible without a team strongly committed to ship quality software. How is this really done? How does Eclipse achieve quality and just-in-time delivery?

This talk sheds light on the key practices of the Eclipse development process - from the development mantras "Always Beta", "Milestones First", "API First", and "Performance First" to practices such as ensuring quality through multiple feedback loops. Erich will reflect on proven practices for managing a large project performed by geographically dispersed teams and open source contributors in a highly competitive market. Most of these practices have evolved in the open source project, but they are equally applicable to closed source projects and will help to improve quality, timeliness and reduce development stress in both types of environments.

Bio

Erich Gamma is a member of the Eclipse project management committee and leads the Eclipse Java Development tools project. He is also a member of the Gang of Four, which is known for their book: Design Patterns - Elements of Reusable Object-Oriented Software. Erich has paired with Kent Beck to develop JUnit, the de-facto standard testing tool for Java. Erich also paired with Kent Beck to write the book "Contributing to Eclipse: Principles, Patterns, and Plug-ins". Before joining IBM OTI he was working at Taligent on a never shipped C++ development environment. Erich started with object-oriented programming over 20 years ago as the co-author of ET++ one of the first large scale C++ application frameworks. Erich Gamma is an IBM Distinguished Engineer and the site lead of the IBM OTI Lab in Zurich, Switzerland. He has a doctorate in computer science from the University of Zurich.